265 Westvale Drive, Waterloo, ON. N2T 2B2. 519-746-1965

School Council Meeting Minutes
May 13, 2026 – 6pm

Welcome to those attending –

Name	Present	Name	Present
Catharine Marchand	X	Aya Alkabarity	
Elysia Cloet	X	Vasant Somani	
Lori Burton		Arlene Nancekivell	
Tonya Seip	X	Jennifer Benninger	
Eleanor McGrath	X	Meaghan Boston	
Christine Glidden	X	Sambuddha Sen	
Sheena Kinghorn	X	Farnaz Rajab	
Tamara DeCraemer	X	Melania Vargas Arvizu	
Jennifer Thysman	X	Mike Meech	X
Tammy Lee Hauser	X	Debalina Saha	
Sarah Steinert	X	Rosemary Wyse	
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Welcome Message – Tonya

Territorial Acknowledgment - Catharine

Principals Report – Catharine

- Staff gearing up for term 2 report cards
- EQAO testing is starting
    - Grade 3 testing is May 19-21
    - Grade 6 is May 26-28
    - Students get a chance to practice with sample tests the week before testing happens
    - Sample tests help students to get used to the online environment and make sure they know how to use the digital tools. It also reduces stress for the day of the event.
- Welcome to School - Kindergarten
    - Thursday May 21 at 6:30 pm
    - New families come and get to tour the kindergarten classrooms
    - Council can have a table there to welcome families, and invite them to participate in the council. Catharine will set up a table in the front hall and Tamara will attend. She will collect names/email addresses on a sign up sheet and will give out trinkets from the council cabinet (super balls, jelly bracelets), if any are available.
- PD Day is coming up on May 29 (it's purpose for teachers is around assessment and evaluation)
- Grade 6 had a visit from Centennial today. They took the kids through an orientation presentation in the library.
- Grade 6s go to Centennial on June 10th for a music concert.
- Track and Field

    - June 2nd junior track and field at Westvale, all children participate in the events
    - June 16th county track and field at Jacob Hespler. The top one or two students from each age group will be invited to compete.
- Intramural hockey just wrapped up. It ended in the usual staff vs students show down, and staff beat the students in the finals.
- Grade 6 camp day is June 8th. Students are gone all day and come back late.
- Grade 6 celebration is June 24th 1:20 – 2:40 pm in the outdoor classroom area. There may be cupcakes at this event, and grade 6 parents/caregivers are invited to attend.
- A Teddy Bear Picnic will be coming for kindergarten too (date TBD)
- The last day of school is June 25; there is a PD day on June 26

Teacher's Report- Lori Burton

- Big thank you to Mr. McGrath for running the science fair!
- The smaller boards worked really well.
- Big thank you also to everyone who helped at the book fair, the children were really excited for this event.
- May 6 was Kodali choir. 35 students participated. It was a well-loved event by the children.
- The chicks have hatched! Their names are: Chika, Pinecone, Sir Chirpsalot, Midnight, and Snuggly B.
- 5 chicks hatched out of 7 hatched, and it all happened around 3:10 pm so children got to watch on the livestream from their classes!
- Jump rope for heart is on Friday.
- Classes will be collecting donations for Raffle Baskets for the fun fair. We have 12 raffle basket themes picked so far; some teaches have teamed up. Announcements will go out later about which theme each class is collecting. Donations are most welcome, but 100% optional.
- Butterfly kits
    - The butterfly kits have arrived, and they are in Room 22 (an empty classroom)
    - Kids can go in and observe with magnifying glasses
    - Classes are going in to look as part of science curriculum
    - We got 22 and 21 formed a chrysalis
    - These will be released into the butterfly garden

Treasurer's Report – Eleanor McGrath/Tonya

- Our financials are always available to review at: tinyurl.com/westvalefinancials
- Account balance is: $13,983.03
    - $4,471.38 in available funds (less commitments, and minimum account balance of 3k)
- Revenue this month:
    - Scholastic: 5369.50 cash sales - but this is remitted to Scholastic
    - Fundscrip $89.12
- Expenses this month:
    - Butterfly kits ($176.74)
    - Donation to N4L (as voted in Feb - $700)
    - Science fair poster boards ($308.62)
    - Classroom outdoor equipment and event tents (as voted in Feb, total $1844.53)
- Outstanding Commitments

    - Carnaval (cups) $44.06
    - Sensory path: $1,300.00 – This been purchased, but won't be installed until floors are refinished.
    - Communication board: $709.00 – This will probably not happen until next year. However, the school has purchased another one with school funds which will be mounted on the school wall outside. The one council is paying for will be near one of the playgrounds, possibly installed on a half-height fence. The school is looking into adding a low fence to help enclose part of the playground better for our non-verbal ASD students. If installed, the school-council funded sign would be posted in this area attached to the fence.
    - Chicks $34.59
    - Grade 6 trip 2026: $1,000.00
    - Fun Fair: $1,000.00
- There remains $3500-$4000 that we could spend e.g. on the sound system equipment, corn hole as previous discussed, and/or other items.
- It was recommended that we vote on some of these things now, so that they can be purchased in time for the Fun Fair. Eleanor reminds us that while we don't necessarily need to spend all $4k, but as always - we shouldn't be hoarding money.
- Costco currently has: Corn Hole = $100; Giant Tetris = $100; Giant Yahtzee = $35 (and probably others?). Catharine says we have to do cornhole through Marchants (for $330 approx), but we can do the giant games from Costco. A council member would need to purchase at Costco and submit their receipts.
- Scholastic Details
    - Total sales were over $8000
        - $8595.25 minus $601.67 in applicable taxes leaving us with a Net Sales amount of $7993.58
        - Scholastic Dollars are calculated on the Net Sales amount, meaning we have $3996.79 in Scholastic Dollars in our account.
        - We should discuss priorities for Council and the Teachers.
    - We had to handle a lot of cash when the debit machines went offline due to a Rogers outage.
    - Cash deposit incurs School-Day Fees, so we should anticipate approx $155 in fees for the flow-through of Scholastic cash from our account to a cheque. This should still be within what was budgeted for SchoolDay fees for the year.

WRAPSC -Tamara

- The last meeting was a meet and greet with the trustees. There was just a 10 minute intro and then they cut it off if you weren't in person, and Tamara was not in person.
- Sarah announced this is her last year, and they are actively looking for someone to take over as chair.

Parent involvement night update – Christine

- We have completed 2 out of our 4 wellness sessions.
- Both of the anxiety seminars were well done, but attendance was light. We had council volunteers and one family at each session.

- We still have Yoga and Family Fitness happening, and will look to see if attendance is any better for those events.
- The recommendation going forward is to avoid seminars as part of PIC funding. Our best engagement happens with activities and events.
- It was also suggested we do it earlier in the year when families would like to be inside, instead of during May when the weather is finally turning nicer.
- Using the PIC funds for a physical item that persists (like the yoga mats) is a good way to spend the grant, as even if the events themselves are not well attended, those resources can be used by Westvale Students.
- For next year, some suggestions might be to purchase a bunch of board games and do family board game night, or purchase Sphero robots and do family coding in the library.

Principal profile form-Tonya and Tamara will complete

- Tonya and Tamara to complete this before Friday.
- Catharine reassured us that just because this form is being sent, it doesn't mean the principal is being reassigned.

Science Fair Update – Eleanor

- It was an immense success!! Big thank you to all volunteers (set-up, tear down, judges) and to Catharine for making everything happen!
- There were approximately 90 projects (about 5 no-shows)
- The smaller boards seemed to work fine for the kids and also worked a bit better for placement on the tables (and it meant less of a financial "loss" for the no-shows).
- We received some lovely feedback from happy parents
- Volunteers got certificates to give out to the children to acknowledge their participation, volunteers were assigned to different zones in the gym to review their projects
- Kids were excited, some were very enthusiastic to explain their projects.
- Some kids were not able to attend in the evening, so their boards were there unattended
- There was a suggestion to have the student include their names on the boards so judges can find the right kids to discuss their projects and distribute certificates. Tonya noted that it was hard to find the kids if they didn't put their boards in the right spot on the map.

Scholastic – Christine

- This was a hugely successful event!
- We ran the fair from Monday – Weds on the week of April 27th.
- Wish Lists
    - Each student was given a printed blank wishlist to use to write down books they were interested in.
    - Teachers were also given a printed blank wishlist for books they'd like for their classrooms. Families could choose to purchase and donate books to their child's classroom.
- Monday
    - Student previews happened between 9:00 and 3:20 – classes could sign up for a specific period
    - 3:20 pm – 4:30 pm (students and families)

- Tuesday we were open
    - 8:30 am – 9 am (students and families)
    - 9 am – 3:20 pm (students only)
    - 3:20 pm – 8:30 pm (students and families)
- Wednesday we were open
    - 8:30 am – 9 am (students and families)
    - 9 am – 2 pm (students only)
- Lots of help from volunteers. Many, many thanks to everyone who helped out!

Chicks Update – Tonya

- Chicks are here! Out of 7 eggs, 5 were born
- Had the hatch live online
- Chicks will be leaving the school Friday May 22nd

Fun Fair Update – Sheena

- Fun fair is June 17th 6-8
- We need LOTS of volunteers. If you are interested, please look for an announcement coming out soon with a Google form you can complete.
    - There will be opportunities to set up, clean up, monitor various stations, and donate baked goods for our cake walk.
- Raffle Baskets
    - This year the Raffle Basket Themes were sent out via Google Sheets so teachers can fill in their choices directly. This has greatly streamlined communication between council and teachers, and has allowed teachers to collaborate on themes.
    - Donations for baskets will be due by the end of May (Thursday before PD day), and they will be collected by Jenn T.
    - Several volunteers will assemble baskets at Jenn's House again this year
- We have Sub Committee for Fun Fair, which meets about once a month. This format has been working very well.
- We are renting games this year in addition to a cotton candy machine from ABC rentals in Cambridge.
- UW is also returning for a free STEM activity in the library.

Item Requests -Sheena

- Some items would be useful to the school for events going forward, and Sheena has been working with Mandy to review some vendor options.
- There is interest in a portable sound system as well as some large scale games that can be used at fun fair and at other events.
- Jenn T motioned we spend up to $2000 on these items. Tamara seconded the motion. The majority voted in favour, and the motion passed. A summary of the items is below:
    - Cornhole – Marchands $330
    - Tetris - $100 (Costco)
    - Giant Yatzi - $35 (Costco)
    - Speaker $800 (Best Buy)
    - Microphone (wired) $200

Additional Items for Discussion

- The Butterfly Garden could use some seeds, Sarah interested in working with Lindsay Julian in improving this.
- West Coast Seeds donated seeds $150 in seeds. Christine paid $20 for shipping.
- Christine also bought a wireless doorbell for $23.38 to use for our events, which worked really well for the PIC events and for Scholastic and can be used at our events doing forward.
- Jenn T motioned that Christine be reimbursed for the doorbell and seed shipping amount. Tamara seconded. The majority voted in favour, and the motion passed.

Next Meeting Date – June 10th, 2026 from 6-7:30 pm

Future Meeting Dates –June 10 from 6-7:30 pm.